Evaluating Websites Teaching Demo

SOC 01
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March 11, 2025

AGENDA

01 Library Services

02 SIFT vs. CRAAP Methods

03 CCSF Student Testimonies

04 Scenarios using SIFT

CCSF Library

SIFT vs. CRAAP

Question for all: How many of you remember the CRAAP method? What does the acronym stand for?

Key Differences:

Feature	SIFT	CRAAP
Scope	Quick online fact-checking	Comprehensive academic evaluation
Focus	Digital misinformation	Scholarly credibility
Depth	Surface-level verification	In-depth analysis of sources
Speed	Fast, real-time	Time-consuming, detailed
Application	News, social media, online info	Academic papers, formal research

ChatGPT. Response to a question about the difference between SIFT and CRAAP methods. OpenAI, 7 Mar. 2025.

Bonus question: What is lateral reading?

What CCSF Students say about Evaluating Sources:

Why is it important to evaluate sources?

What about Wikipedia? How do you use it well?

Portland Community College Library. "Library Sources." *YouTube*, 29 May 2015, https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=w19t0mlqW2A.

It's clear that peer reviewed/scholarly articles are valuable, but what about popular sources(i.e. news, .com domains, etc.)?

Scenario #1 SIFT with Youtube

Is this fact or fake?

Fact-check in pairs and share aloud.

Strategies?

Introducing the self-driving bicycle in the Netherlands

Some sites to remember during lateral reading when you investigate:

- ✓ Snopes.com
- ✓ FactCheck.org
- ✓ Leadstories.com
- ✓ Wikipedia.com

Scenario #2 SIFT with Social Media

Video post on X published on March 5, 2025

"Mexico has shut down its border with US due to tariffs taking effect today"

Some sites to remember during lateral reading when you investigate:

- ✓ Snopes.com
- ✓ FactCheck.org
- ✓ Leadstories.com
- ✓ Wikipedia.com

Let's "sift" through some lateral reading:

Google "Mexico has shut down its border with the US due to tariffs" and **Lead Stories**

https://leadstories.com/hoax-alert/2025/03/fact-check-mexico-border-crossing-closed-video.html

What do we learn about when this video was actually posted?

The Factcheck website also references this: CBP.GOV

Scenario #3 SIFT with News

Trump + Musk's claim: Millions and millions of people over 100 years may be receiving improper payments from Social Security.

Age Range	Count
0-9	38,825,456
10-19	44,326,480
20-29	47,995,478
30-39	52,106,915
40-49	47,626,581
50-59	45,740,805
60-69	46,381,281
70-79	33,404,412
80-89	15,165,127
90-99	6,054,154
100-109	4,734,407
110-119	3,627,007
120-129	3,472,849
130-139	3,936,311
140-149	3,542,044
150-159	1,345,083
160-169	121,807
170-179	6,087
180-189	695
190-199	448
200-209	879
210-219	866
220-229	1,039
240-249	1
360-369	1

Screenshot by Elon Musk

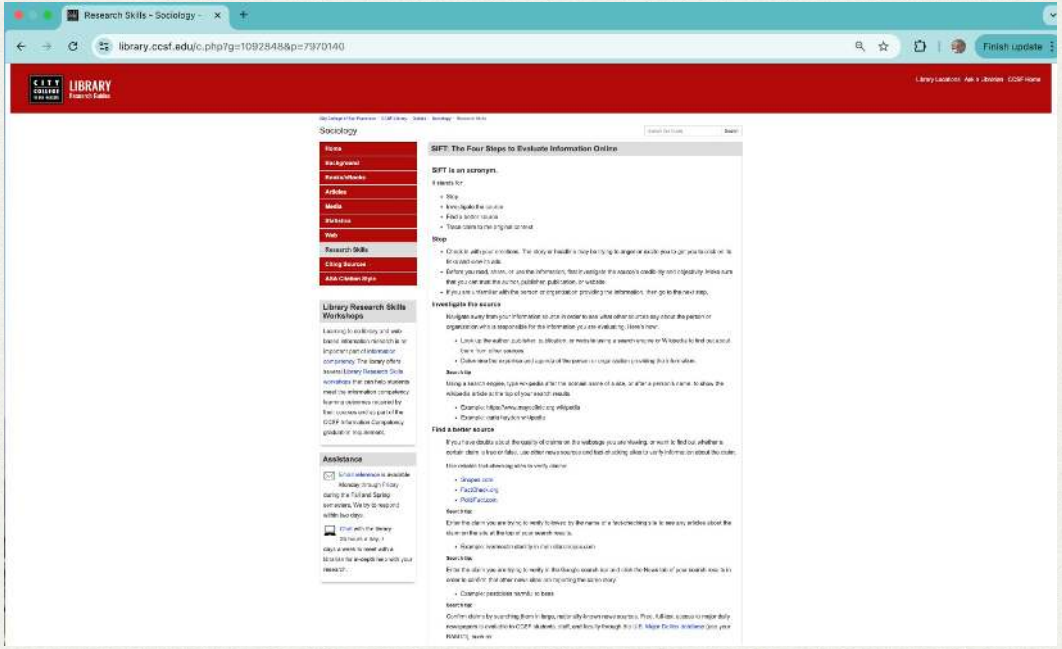
What do fact checking sites say?

Takeaway: Overall, while Musk is correct that tens of millions of dead Americans are still listed as alive in Social Security databases, only a tiny fraction of these mislabeled individuals still receive benefits.

Some sites to remember during lateral reading when you investigate:

- ✓ Snopes.com
- ✓ FactCheck.org
- ✓ Leadstories.com
- ✓ Wikipedia.com

Other Resources



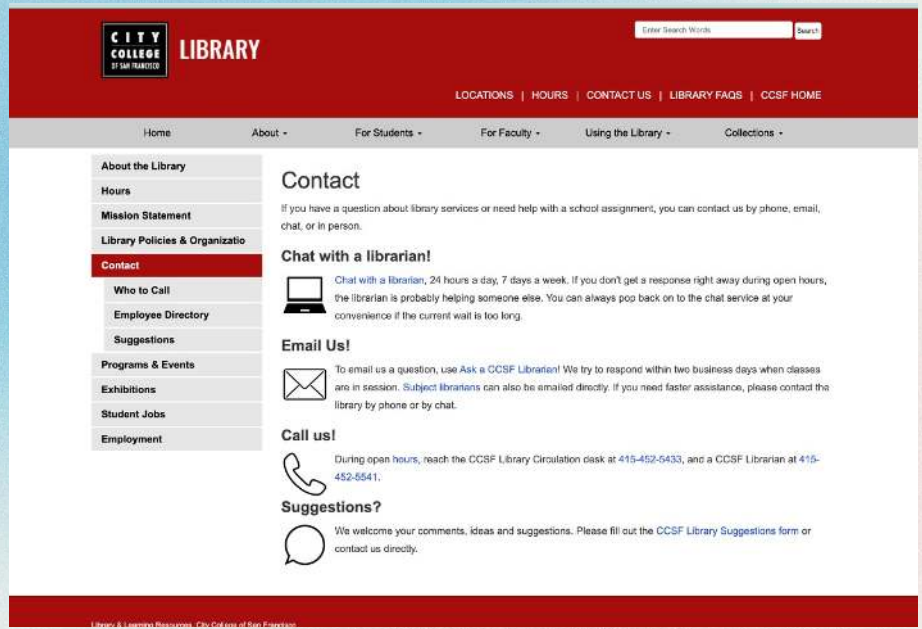
Nonpartisan Think Tanks:

Pew Research

Brookings Institution

Carnegie Endowment for International Peace

This is also in our excellent Sociology Research Guide HERE

Thank you.

Contact the CCSF Library
in multiple ways!